



COVID-19 vaccination passports

The state of New York has launched a digital pass that shows if you've been vaccinated or tested negative. <http://dgit.in/apr21-25>



Apple Watch Redesign

Apple is experimenting with other designs for the Apple Watch, possibly with flexible displays. <http://dgit.in/apr21-26>

AmazonBasics 55-inches 4K Ultra HD Smart LED TV

A unique UI in a sea of homogenous Android TVs



Price
₹39,999

Recently, Amazon launched the AmazonBasics TVs in 32, 43, 50 and 55-inch screen sizes. Priced at ₹39,999, the 55-inch AmazonBasics TV competes with the likes of the Mi TV 4X, Hisense 55A71F, and the Realme SLED TV, to name a few. Is it a worthy contender to consider?



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brightness, but we peg it to be in the ballpark of 350 nits. It also does not appear to have any dimming zones.

PERFORMANCE

Let's start with Dolby Vision content. Playing content like Our Planet and Altered Carbon on Netflix was quite a

pleasant experience. Even in some of the darker sequences, the content was still visible on the screen. Content in Dolby Vision from Netflix looks good with rich colours.

Moving over to HDR content, and this is where things get a little confusing. Consuming HDR content on YouTube works fine with content looking lush. However, it's with HDR 10+ content on Prime Video that we saw a few misses. A show like Jack Ryan Season 2 Episode 2 and the Grand Tour Season 1 Episode 1 had a slight green bias.

When it comes to 4K HDR content, the AmazonBasics TV's performance is at par with what the competition is offering, and that's not a bad thing.

We played a lot of FHD content on the TV like Young Sheldon. Young Sheldon has a vibrant colour pallet,

and it looks good on this TV. There are some night sequences where the content can get a little muddy, but nothing that's out of the ordinary for this price.

USER INTERFACE

The AmazonBasics TV is running on the Fire TV OS. You can switch HDMI sources as well using Alexa on this TV which is pretty cool. The UI is as smooth and it supports all the popular streaming services available, including Apple TV. Overall, the UI barely lagged, making me feel like a Fire TV stick was connected to the TV. Alexa also works like a charm. The Fire TV UI is more fluid than what we have seen on some budget Android TVs.

REMOTE CONTROL

The remote control is ergonomic, and just like the Fire TV remote control has all the buttons neatly laid out. We have dedicated hotkeys for Prime Video, Netflix, Amazon Music and a dedicated button to bring up your apps.

VERDICT

The AmazonBasics Fire TV edition TV is priced competitively when looking at the 55-inch budget TV space. The most significant advantage this TV has is the UI. We have seen Android TVs in the budget space lag with some heavy multitasking, and while the AmazonBasics TV isn't perfect, its UI brings a bit more fluidity. The TV's picture quality is acceptable and at par with what the competition offers in this price segment. There is some input lag when gaming on this TV though. Overall, we can safely recommend the AmazonBasics TV as a contender for those looking for a budget smart TV.

—Sameer Mitha

BUILD AND DESIGN

The display has relatively slim bezels, and two metal feet hold the TV in place. The AmazonBasics Fire TV has an AV-in port, IR pass-through, antenna, 2 USB ports, 3 HDMI ports, optical port and a LAN port for connectivity options. The TV also supports Bluetooth and dual-band Wi-Fi.

DISPLAY AND PICTURE QUALITY

Kicking things off with the display, the AmazonBasics Fire TV Edition TV has an IPS panel which means you can expect good viewing angles with some compromise to the black levels. However, if there is some bias lighting in the room, the blacks look quite alright. It is a 4K panel with support for HDR 10, HDR 10+ and Dolby Vision. We do not know the panel's maximum

SPECIFICATIONS

PANEL SIZE: 55-inch | PANEL TYPE: IPS LED | PANEL RESOLUTION: 3840 x 2160 - 4K | PANEL REFRESH RATE: 60Hz | HDR 10 SUPPORT: Yes | HDR 10+ SUPPORT: Yes | DOLBY VISION SUPPORT: Yes | WEIGHT: 10.3 kgs | HDMI PORTS: 3 | USB PORTS: 2 | BLUETOOTH: Yes | WI-FI: Yes | ETHERNET: Yes | SPEAKERS: 20W | BUILT-IN STORAGE: 8GB

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